NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



Child of the Last Flame

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

Child of the Last Flame

One more little light, struck against the cold.

The snow came down on the last night of the year as if it meant to bury the town. In a doorway between two tall houses, out of the wind but not out of the cold, a girl sat with her bare feet tucked under her and a bundle of little lights in her lap. She had walked the streets since noon calling them out. No one had bought a single one, and she did not dare go home with the bundle still full.

Through a frosted window across the street she could see a kitchen: a stove glowing orange, a table laid for a feast, a goose browning in its own steam. From somewhere further down came the smell of roast apples, from a house that was not hers. She had been hungry so long that the hunger had stopped hurting and become a kind of weight, pressing her into the step.

She struck one light to warm her fingers. For as long as it burned the doorway was gone, and she sat beside a great iron stove. It went out, and the cold came back worse. She struck another, and another. In each flame there was something she had wanted: the stove, the feast, a tree hung with a thousand candles. And in the last flame, the one she had saved, there was the one who used to hold her before she was gone, her grandmother, holding out her arms and saying it was time to come home.

In the morning they found her in the doorway, smiling, with a handful of burnt-out ends. The old ferryman would not carry her; she had no coin, only cinders. So she came to you. She is small and very tired, and she still has a few lights left. Walk slowly with her. She has never been anywhere warm.



What the Ferrymen know

She came to the river already carrying light, so her crossing begins with three. Her small flames shield her: the first crack in each Reach does not touch her. She has never wandered in her life; she waits where she is told, and is never Adrift. She has lost so much already that she can let one more memory go before she Fades. And the harshest Mists will not come near a child.

Twist: Starts with 3 Light. The first Fracture in each Reach is ignored. Never drifts Adrift. She can forget 1 more card before she Fades. No harsh Mist.

Key Memory: *the one who used to hold me before she was gone*



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach: page I, *Who I Was* (Reach I); page II, *What I Did* (Reach II); page III, *What I Carry* (Reach III). Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which complete a sentence about the soul's life.

Inscribing. When a card Resonates, you may inscribe it if the slot shown on the card is still empty on the page of the Reach the soul is in. A **Key Memory** may be inscribed whenever it is played face up, Resonating or not. To inscribe, put the card in its slot with photo corners instead of discarding it; it stays there for the rest of the game. Oblivion cards and Burned cards cannot be inscribed.

Page rewards. Each page pays a small reward for each pair of neighbouring slots: **Place + Person**, **Person + Deed** and **Deed + Feeling**. When an inscription fills the second slot of a pair, do that pair's reward at once. One card can complete two pairs (a Person inscribed next to a Place and a Deed): do both. Each reward happens once per page; tick its box in the Book. The rewards are printed on each page:

Chapter Blessing. When all 4 slots of a page are filled (3 for the Garland Girl), the page also gives one Chapter Blessing at once (only once per page). The Blessing is not chosen. Check these in order and do the first one that is possible:

If the soul has at least one Fracture: remove 1 Fracture (from the highest well).

Otherwise, if any space has Black Water: remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul from the game.

Otherwise, if the forgotten pile has any cards: move the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

Otherwise nothing happens.

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners into the photo corners. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...



PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

I loved...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I once...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

and ever since I have carried...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ PLACE + PERSON
Place 1 Root.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Bloom 1 Root.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Gain 2 Light.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐☐☐

II · What I Did

At...



before...



I...



The price was...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Banish the nearest Shade.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Drain the nearest Black Water.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Mend 1 Fracture.

☐ DEED + FEELING
The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

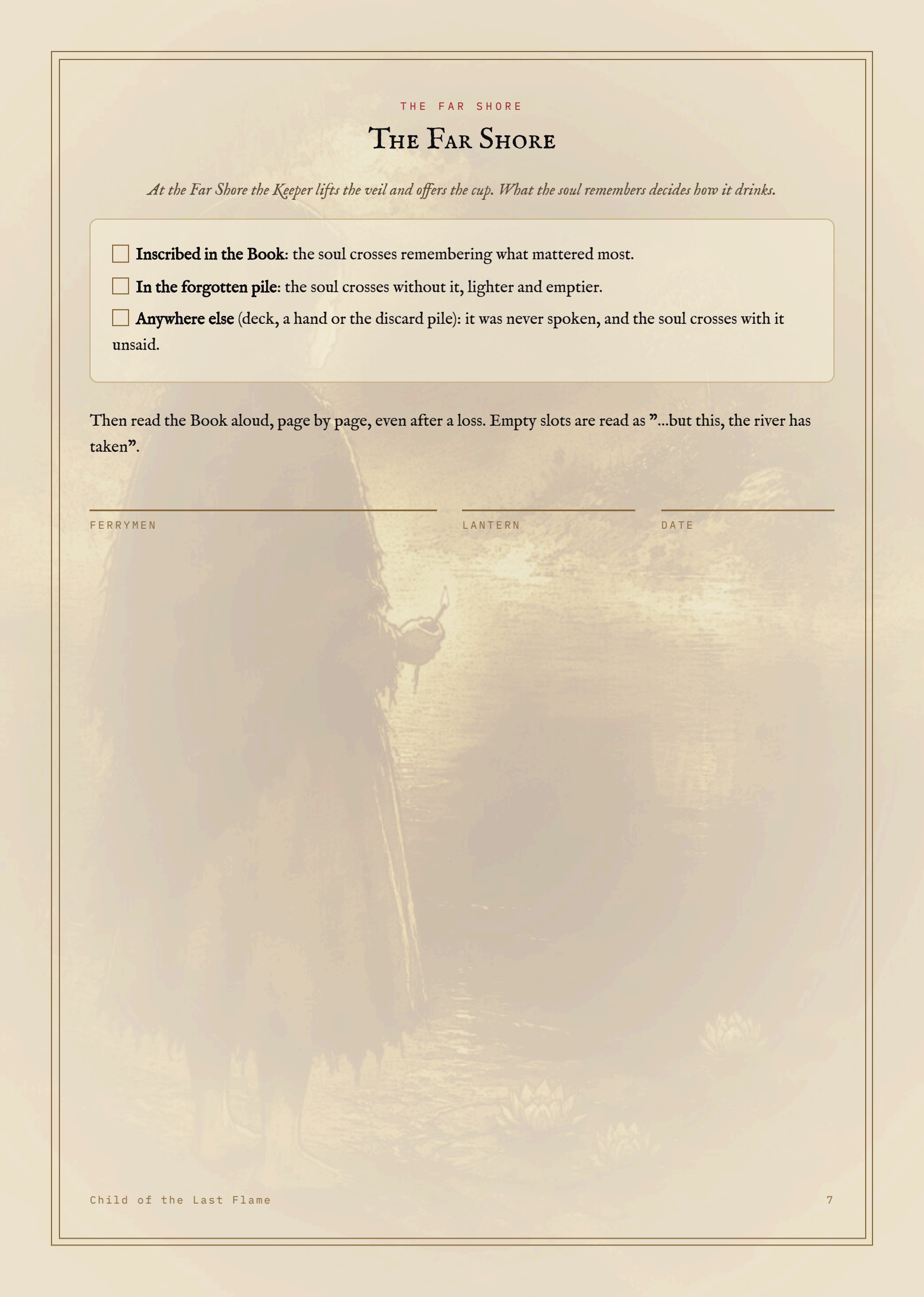
The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: the soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **In the forgotten pile**: the soul crosses without it, lighter and emptier.
- ☐ **Anywhere else** (deck, a hand or the discard pile): it was never spoken, and the soul crosses with it unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page, even after a loss. Empty slots are read as "...but this, the river has taken".

FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____





NETHERBLOOM

RALPH LAUXIE